

f³⁵ P⁷² ⚭ ABC	6	[Since this combination attests over 90% of the words, it is irrelevant to my present purpose and will not be used in any computations below.]
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involving P ⁷²	9
involving ⚭	25
involving A	20
involving B	11
involving C	18
involving 048	6

For the 61 variant sets that are left (67 minus 6), **f³⁵** has overt attestation from these early uncials 69% of the time. Not only are these uncials obviously independent of each other, **f³⁵** is independent of them as well, but just as early. Here is a further demonstration that **f³⁵** is both early and independent. As we move to the next section, keep in mind that all by itself **f³⁵** proves that a variant is early.

f³⁵ minority readings

A look at my apparatus will show that I have designated as genuine seven readings with an attestation of 33% or less. In each case the deciding factor is the presence of **f³⁵**. I will now analyze these seven readings, beginning with the smallest percentage.

ⱼζ 2:2 [20%]

ECM lists only cursive 18 for this reading, but my own collation of 35 convinces me that it agrees with 18; as do another 38 family representatives that I have collated. So the family is solid. Von Soden cites one other MS for this reading, while Tischendorf is silent. So the reading survived outside the family, if not very widely. Is the antecedent of the pronoun the debaucheries, or the people involved in them? Either makes sense, but it is really the bad conduct that sullies the reputation of the Way. I take it that **f³⁵** probably preserves the Original reading here.

συνεστωτα 3:5 ⚭ [23%]

Peter's syntax here is a bit complex, giving rise to eleven variations for the six-word phrase. As I see it, "out of water and through water" is parenthetical, modifying 'land', so the participle works with **ησαν** as a periphrastic construction whose subject includes both 'heaven' [m] and 'earth' [f]—thus the nominative plural neuter perfect active participle. **f³⁵** is precisely correct here, even if most copyists got lost in Peter's syntax. ⚭ gives overt 4th century attestation, but this reading is also attested by another four independent lines of transmission (as cited by *ECM*), besides